MarginOS Spec Amendment v16.4: Free data kept for 24 hours; original files deleted after import

For: Design & Development Agent (handover) and Akthar Uddin
Amends: MarginOS Product Spec v16 (`/workspace/spec.md`): new section 15.F, plus the changes listed below and the section 14 log. Builds on v16.1–v16.3.
Date: 29 October 2026
Status: Approved by Akthar Uddin on 29 October 2026: Free 24-hour deletion, raw-file deletion for Free and Pro, Pro unchanged, upgrade within 24 hours keeps the data. **K8–K11 were also decided by Akthar on 29 October 2026 (F9).** K8 changed from the recommendation; K9–K11 are as recommended. The privacy wording is pending legal review.

What changes elsewhere in the spec

Section	Change
Title, intro and status	Version is now "v16, with amendments v16.1, v16.2, v16.3 and v16.4"
2 (Positioning)	Approved Free vs Pro wording and the privacy line (K10; privacy line pending legal review)
7 (Free tier)	"Data held" is now one order dataset at a time, kept for 24 hours (with its cost data). New line: Free data is deleted 24 hours after upload, with notices and time left
8 (Pro, Data in)	The upgrade carries over Free data only if it is still within its 24 hours
10.1 criteria 1, 12, 13	24-hour clocks. Criterion 13 is replaced (no 30-day rule, no reminder email)
10.2 criterion 8; new criterion 13	Free users can use the data export before deletion. New: original files are deleted after import (Free and Pro)
10.3 criteria 12 and 23	Refunded or charged-back Pro: data is kept until account deletion or Start fresh, export-only while not Pro, and restored if Pro returns (K8). The upgrade cancels the 24-hour clocks
12.4 (Free tier rules)	"Data held" and the deletion rule are replaced by 24 hours. The 3-a-day limit is kept (K9, approved)
12.6 (Data and privacy)	New rule for original files. Free retention is 24 hours. The upgrade rule is updated. Refunded Pro follows K8 (kept data with the 24-month rule). The delayed-payment pause is added (K11). The privacy policy and DPA retention wording are updated (K10)
12.7 (Data model)	The upgrade stops the 24-hour clocks, and only data still held carries over
13 (Known risks)	New risk: Free users losing work after 24 hours
15.C K5 note	The email service no longer sends a Free reminder
15.E E6	Refers to the 24-hour clocks, not the 30-day inactivity rule. Start fresh also deletes the kept ex-Pro data (K8)
14 (Open questions log)	New entry Q7

15.F Amendment v16.4: Free data kept for 24 hours; raw files deleted after import (approved 29 October 2026)

Akthar approved this on 29 October 2026, to keep storage cost and privacy risk low: Pro stays as it is, and Free data is deleted 24 hours after upload. v16.4 ***changes the Free tier and data retention*** *(approved). It changes no prices. Akthar decided the four related points (K8–K11) on 29 October 2026 (F9). K8 differs from the recommendation; K9–K11 are as recommended. v16.4 replaces the matching wording in sections 7, 10.1, 10.3, 12.4, 12.6, 12.7 and 15.E, which now point here.*

F1. Free: everything is deleted 24 hours after upload

- **What is deleted:** all of a Free user's data: the order dataset, the MarginOS template and its cost data (unit, packaging, shipping and return costs), ad spend, manual entries and calculator inputs. Overheads are Pro only

(section 8), so a Free user has none.

- **The clock (decided): each successful upload has its own 24-hour clock**, which starts at the moment that import succeeds. An Etsy set (or any multi-file set) is one upload with one clock (section 6).
    - The clock covers only the data that upload brought in. For example, an order file uploaded at 10:00 is deleted at 10:00 the next day, and a template uploaded at 18:00 is deleted at 18:00 the next day.
    - A new upload that **replaces** older data (12.4) deletes the old data straight away. The new data gets its own new 24-hour clock.
    - **Manual entries and calculator inputs** each get a 24-hour clock from when they were **first saved**. Editing them later does not restart the clock.
    - A failed or cancelled import starts no clock and changes no existing clock.
    - Nothing else restarts or extends a clock: not signing in, not viewing, not exporting, not editing.
- **Replaces:** the "deleted after 30 days without a sign-in" rule and the 7-day reminder email (12.4, 12.6, 10.1 criterion 13). No reminder or deletion email is sent for Free data.
- **Data held:** "one order dataset plus one template at a time" becomes **"one order dataset at a time, kept for 24 hours"**. The dataset's cost data (one MarginOS template plus manual entries) is held with it and also kept for 24 hours. Replacement still works as in 12.4: a new order file replaces the order dataset, and a new template replaces the template.
- **Exactly at 24 hours:** the data becomes **inaccessible in the app**: results, "Show the maths", calculators and the data export all stop showing it. This happens even if the clean-up job has not run yet. The data is then removed from live storage within 1 hour.
- **Sample data** (15.E) is built in, not uploaded, so it has no 24-hour clock.

F2. Telling the Free user (requirements only; layout is for Design)

- **Before upload:** the upload area says plainly that Free uploads are deleted 24 hours after upload. Suggested wording: "Free uploads are deleted after 24 hours. Upgrade to Pro to keep your data."
- **After upload:** the import summary gives the exact deletion date and time in the user's time zone.
- **While data is held:** the **time left** is shown wherever Free results are shown, for example "Deleted in 23 h 12 min". Where uploads have different clocks, the earliest one is shown, with each upload's time listed on request.
- **Last hour:** the user is told when less than 1 hour is left, with a link to download their data and an upgrade prompt.
- **After deletion:** a returning user sees a short message that their Free data was deleted after 24 hours, then the empty starting state with the upload prompt.

F3. Downloading data before deletion (checked against 10.2 criterion 8 and section 8)

- Free users can use the **privacy data export** that all users have (10.2 criterion 8; 12.6) at any time before deletion. It downloads their cleaned order rows and cost data as CSV.
- Free has **no results export**: PDF reports are Pro (section 8), and v16.4 does not change that.
- The export contains the **cleaned rows**, never the original file (F5).

F4. Pro: unchanged

- Pro data is kept until the user deletes it, under the 24-month inactivity rule with emails 60 and 30 days before (12.6). Saved datasets, the Pro shop and fair use (12.5, 12.7) are unchanged.

F5. Free and Pro: the original uploaded file is deleted after import

- The original uploaded file (raw CSV, or each file in a multi-file set) is used **only to import**. It is **deleted as soon as the import has succeeded, failed or been cancelled**. Only the cleaned rows are kept (customer personal data already stripped, section 6).
- **Abandoned imports:** if the user leaves an import unfinished (for example at a preview or column-mapping step), it counts as cancelled after **1 hour** and the file is deleted (K11, approved).
- The raw file is held only in **temporary storage that is not backed up**. If any backup still captures one, it is gone within the **30-day backup window** (10.2 criterion 8) and is never restored.

- The raw file is never used for the data export, error reports, logs or support (section 6 already keeps stripped values out of logs). Re-reading a file means uploading it again. In Free, a re-upload counts as an upload as usual (12.4).

F6. Backups (checked against 10.2 criterion 8 and 15.E E6)

- **In the app:** Free data is inaccessible from the 24-hour mark (F1).
- **Live storage:** it is removed within 1 hour after that.
- **Backups:** any backup that holds it ages out within the existing **30-day** window, the same as account deletion (10.2 criterion 8) and Start fresh (15.E E6).
- **Restores:** backups are **never** used to bring back Free data that has expired. If a backup is ever restored for disaster recovery, any Free data whose 24 hours have passed, and any raw file, is deleted again before users get access. This keeps "24 hours in the app" and "30 days in backups" consistent.

F7. Upgrading to Pro within the 24 hours (checked against 10.3 criterion 23, 12.6, 12.7)

- If Pro is granted (payment confirmed, 12.10) **before a clock ends**, every running 24-hour clock is cancelled. The Free data still held is carried into the Pro shop as before (12.7), and Pro retention applies from the purchase.
- Data whose clock already ended is not recovered. If nothing is left, the Pro shop starts empty.
- 10.3 criterion 23, 12.6 and 12.7 are updated to refer to the 24-hour clocks instead of the 30-day timer and its reminder. There is no reminder to cancel.
- **Delayed payments (K11, approved):** while a completed checkout has a pending delayed payment, the 24-hour clocks are paused. If Pro is granted they are cancelled. If the payment fails, any data whose clock would already have ended is deleted at once.

F8. Acceptance criteria (v16.4)

1. **Free data inaccessible after 24 hours:** a Free order file uploaded at 10:00 is visible in results at 09:59 the next day. At 10:00 it is gone from results, "Show the maths", calculators and the data export, and the user sees the "deleted after 24 hours" message. Live storage no longer holds it after 11:00.
2. **Separate clocks:** a template uploaded at 18:00 the same day is still available at 10:01 the next day and is deleted at 18:00.
3. **Replacement:** uploading a new order file at 15:00 deletes the earlier order dataset at once, and the new dataset shows a deletion time of 15:00 the next day.
4. **No extension:** signing in, viewing, exporting or editing never changes the time left, and no reminder or deletion email is sent.
5. **Notices:** before upload the 24-hour rule is stated. After upload the import summary shows the exact deletion time in the user's time zone. Free results show the time left, and a notice appears when less than 1 hour is left.
6. **Export before deletion:** a Free user can download their cleaned rows and cost data as CSV before the 24 hours end. The export never contains the original file.
7. **Raw file not stored:** after a successful, failed or cancelled import (Free or Pro), the original file is not in storage. An import left unfinished for 1 hour is cancelled and its file deleted. The raw file is in no backup older than 30 days.
8. **Upgrade within 24 hours keeps the data:** a Free user who buys Pro 23 hours after uploading keeps all their data and results in the Pro shop as a saved dataset, no deletion happens at 24 hours, and Pro retention applies.
9. **Upgrade after 24 hours:** a Free user who buys Pro 25 hours after uploading starts with an empty Pro shop.
10. **Pro unchanged:** Pro data is still held after 24 hours, after 30 days and after 23 months without a sign-in. The 24-month rule (12.6) still applies.
11. **Restore safety:** in a restore test, expired Free data and raw files are deleted before the app is opened to users.
12. **Refunded Pro keeps data (K8):** after a full refund, the user's Pro data is still held 30 days, 6 months and 23 months later (with sign-ins). It can be downloaded as CSV from settings but appears in no results. A new Free upload is deleted after 24 hours and doesn't change the kept data. If Pro becomes active again, the shop and saved datasets return unchanged. Start fresh or account deletion removes it.
13. **Kept data and inactivity (K8):** an ex-Pro user with no sign-in for 24 months is emailed 60 and 30 days before, and the kept order data is then deleted. Signing in cancels this.

14. **Delayed payment pause (K11):** a Free user's upload at 10:00, with a delayed payment pending from 09:00 the next day until 11:00 that day, is still held at 10:30. If the payment succeeds it is kept as Pro. If it fails at 11:00 the data is deleted at once.
15. **Upload limit unchanged (K9):** a Free user still gets 3 successful uploads a day, and a re-upload after 24-hour deletion counts as one.

F9. Akthar's decisions on K8–K11 (all decided, 29 October 2026)

- **K8, refunded or charged-back Pro: decided (changed from the recommendation).**
  - The user's data is **not** deleted after 30 days. It is **kept until the user deletes their account or uses Start fresh** (15.E).
  - While the account doesn't have Pro, the data is available **only as a CSV export from settings**. It is not used in results.
  - It is **restored unchanged** (shop and saved datasets) if Pro becomes active again, for example after a refund that fails, a dispute reversed or a new purchase.
  - New Free uploads follow the 24-hour rule and are kept apart from it.
  - The **Pro 24-month inactivity rule** (12.6) also applies to this kept data: with no sign-in for 24 months the user is emailed 60 and 30 days before, and the kept order data is then deleted. Signing in cancels this.
  - **Note for Akthar (not a blocker):** the 24-month rule deletes only *uploaded order data* and was written for Pro accounts, so cost data (templates, ad spend, overheads) stays until the account is deleted, as it does for Pro. An ex-Pro user who has been refunded but signs in at least once every 24 months keeps their data stored without paying. Fair use (500,000 orders, 12.5) still caps it. Storage cost should be watched after launch.
- **K9, 3 uploads a day: approved.** The limit stays as it is (12.4). A re-upload after 24-hour deletion counts as an upload.
- **K10, sales and privacy wording: approved** (privacy wording **pending legal review**), now in section 2:
  - Free column: "Try it on one file, results in minutes. Your data is deleted after 24 hours."
  - "Keep your data, saved datasets and history" is a headline Pro benefit.
  - The pricing page, FAQ and privacy policy say: "Free uploads are deleted after 24 hours, and original files are deleted as soon as they're imported."
  - The privacy policy's retention section and the DPA are updated to match (12.6), replacing any 30-day Free wording.
  - The Marketing & Content Agent should use this wording.
- **K11, other points: approved as recommended.**
  - **Delayed payments:** the 24-hour clocks pause while a completed checkout has a pending delayed payment. If it fails, any data whose clock would already have ended is deleted at once (F7, 12.6).
  - **Unfinished imports:** an import left unfinished is cancelled after **1 hour** and its file deleted (F5).
  - **Free accounts:** a Free account itself (email and settings) is kept as now. No account retention limit is added.
  - **Already checked, no change:** Start fresh and sample data (15.E), fair use (Pro only) and email (no Free reminder; Amazon SES still needed for verification, password reset and the 24-month emails).

Open questions log entry (spec section 14)

ID	Date raised	Section	Question	Raised by	Answer	Answered by	Amendment
Q7	29 Oct 2026	7, 10.1, 10.2, 10.3, 12.4, 12.6, 12.7, 15.E	Storage cost and privacy: should Free keep data at all, and should original files be kept?	Akthar	**v16.4: approved by Akthar.** Free data deleted 24 hours after each upload (own clock per upload, no reminder); raw files deleted after import for Free and Pro; Pro retention unchanged; upgrading within 24 hours keeps the data (15.F). **K8–K11 decided by Akthar:** K8 refunded or charged-back Pro data kept until account deletion or Start fresh (export only while not Pro, restored if Pro returns, 24-month rule applies); K9 3 uploads a day kept; K10 sales and privacy wording approved (privacy line pending legal review); K11 clocks pause during a pending delayed payment, unfinished imports cancelled after 1 hour, Free accounts kept	Business & Product Agent; Akthar (approved, incl. K8–K11)	v16.4